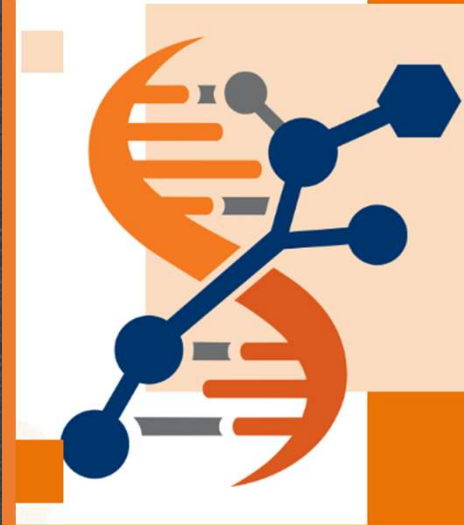


Stefano Manzini

Laboratory of Experimental Pharmacology and  
Integrative Biology of Atherosclerosis

a little of  
**RNAseq**  
History, Theory, Practice



UNIVERSITÀ  
DEGLI STUDI  
DI MILANO

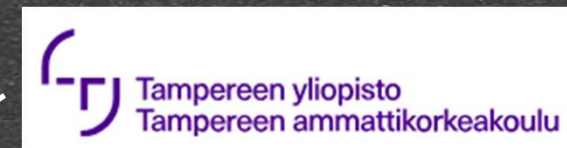
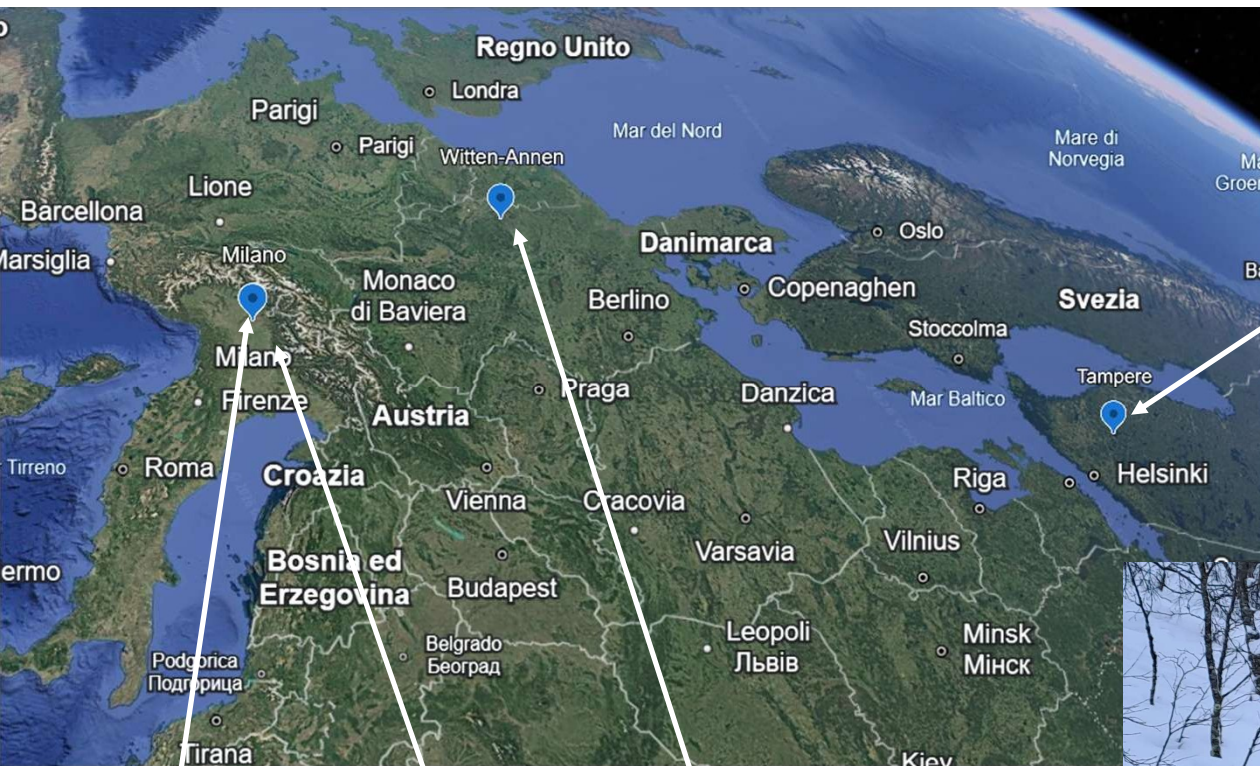
Dipartimento di Eccellenza MUR

2023-2027



Dipartimento di Scienze Farmacologiche e Biomolecolari Rodolfo Paoletti







1, 737-738 (25 April 1953) | doi:10.1050  
**Molecular Structure of Nucleic  
Acids: A Structure for  
Deoxyribose Nucleic Acid**  
J. D. WATSON & F. H. C. CRICK  
L. Medical Research Council Unit for the G.

1953!

## EARLY DAYS OF DNA SEQUENCING

Fifteen years elapsed between the discovery of the DNA double helix and the first experimental determination of a DNA sequence. This delay was caused by several factors that made the problem intimidating:

- (i) The chemical properties of different DNA molecules were so similar that it appeared difficult to separate them.
- (ii) The chain length of naturally occurring DNA molecules was much greater than for proteins and made complete sequencing seems unapproachable.
- (iii) The 20 amino acid residues found in proteins have widely varying properties that had proven useful in the separation of peptides. The existence of only four bases in DNA therefore seemed to make sequencing a more difficult problem for DNA than for protein.
- (iv) No base-specific DNAases were known. Protein sequencing had depended upon proteases that cleave adjacent to certain amino acids.



1977

*Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. USA*  
Vol. 74, No. 2, pp. 560-564, February 1977  
Biochemistry

### **A new method for sequencing DNA**

(DNA chemistry/dimethyl sulfate cleavage/hydrazine/piperidine)

ALLAN M. MAXAM AND WALTER GILBERT

Department of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology, Harvard University, Cambridge, Massachusetts 02138

*Contributed by Walter Gilbert, December 9, 1976*

**ABSTRACT** DNA can be sequenced by a chemical process. The

*Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. USA*  
Vol. 74, No. 12, pp. 5463-5467, December 1977  
Biochemistry

### **DNA sequencing with chain-terminating inhibitors**

(DNA polymerase/nucleotide sequences/bacteriophage  $\phi$ X174)

F. SANGER, S. NICKLEN, AND A. R. COULSON

Medical Research Council Laboratory of Molecular Biology, Cambridge CB2 2QH, England

*Contributed by F. Sanger, October 3, 1977*



Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. USA  
Vol. 74, No. 2, pp. 560-564, February 1977  
Biochemistry

# A new method for sequencing DNA

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## THE SPECIFIC CHEMISTRY

**A Guanine/Adenine Cleavage (2).** Dimethyl sulfate methylates the guanines in DNA at the N7 position and the adenines at the N3 (3). The glycosidic bond of a methylated purine is unstable (3, 4) and breaks easily on heating at neutral pH, leaving the sugar free. Treatment with 0.1 M alkali at 90° then will cleave the sugar from the neighboring phosphate groups. When the resulting end-labeled fragments are resolved on a polyacrylamide gel, the autoradiograph contains a pattern of dark and light bands. The dark bands arise from breakage at guanines, which methylate 5-fold faster than adenines (3).

This strong guanine/weak adenine pattern contains almost half the information necessary for sequencing; however, ambiguities can arise in the interpretation of this pattern because the intensity of isolated bands is not easy to assess. To determine the bases we compare the information contained in this column of the gel with that in a parallel column in which the breakage at the guanines is suppressed, leaving the adenines apparently enhanced.

**An Adenine-Enhanced Cleavage.** The glycosidic bond of methylated adenosine is less stable than that of methylated guanosine (4); thus, gentle treatment with dilute acid releases adenines preferentially. Subsequent cleavage with alkali then produces a pattern of dark bands corresponding to adenines with light bands at guanines.

**Cleavage at Cytosines and Thymines.** Hydrazine reacts with thymine and cytosine, cleaving the base and leaving ribosylurea (5-7). Hydrazine then may react further to produce a hydrazone (5). After a partial hydrazinolysis in 15-18 M aqueous hydrazine at 20°, the DNA is cleaved with 0.5 M piperidine. This cyclic secondary amine, as the free base, displaces all the products of the hydrazine reaction from the sugars and catalyzes the  $\beta$ -elimination of the phosphates. The final pattern contains bands of similar intensity from the cleavages at cytosines and thymines.

**Cleavage at Cytosine.** The presence of 2 M NaCl preferentially suppresses the reaction of thymines with hydrazine. Then, the piperidine breakage produces bands only from cytosine.

# Chemical DNA sequencing

Dimethyl sulfate + slight  
alkali treatment: G + A



Dimethyl sulfate + diluted  
acid: A

Hydrazine + piperidine T + C



Hydrazine + NaCl +  
piperidine: C

purines  
pyrimidines



Proc. Natl. Acad. Sci. USA  
Vol. 74, No. 2, pp. 560-564, February 1977  
Biochemistry

# A new method for sequencing DNA

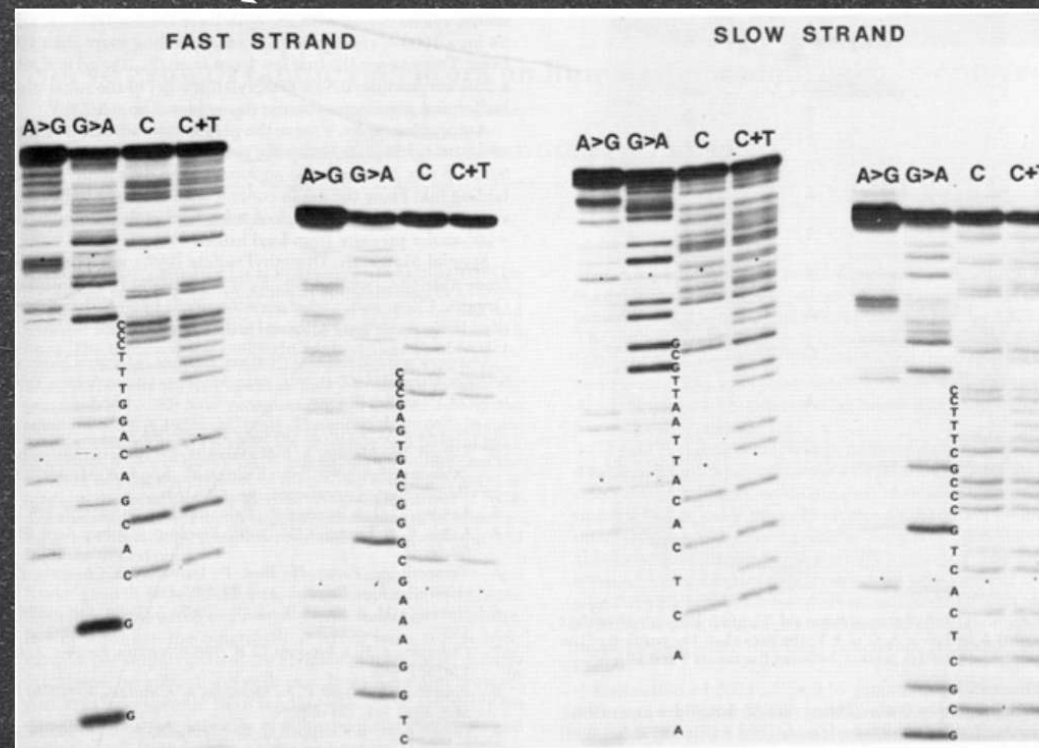
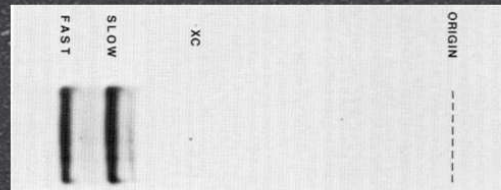
(DNA chemistry/dimethyl sulfate cleavage/hydroxylamine/piperidine)

ALLAN M. MAXAM AND WALTER GILBERT

Department of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology, Harvard University, Cambridge, Massachusetts 02138

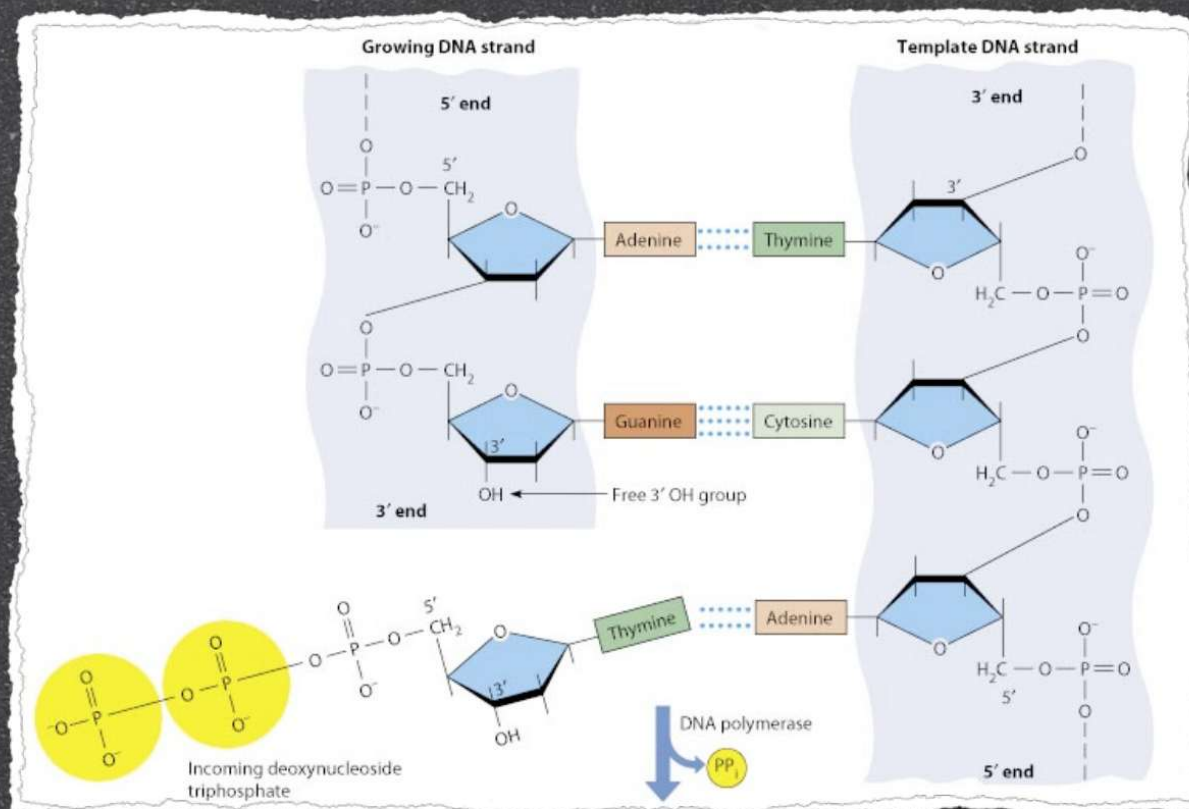
Contributed by Walter Gilbert, December 9, 1976

## Chemical DNA sequencing





Contributed by N. Sengco, October 3, 1977



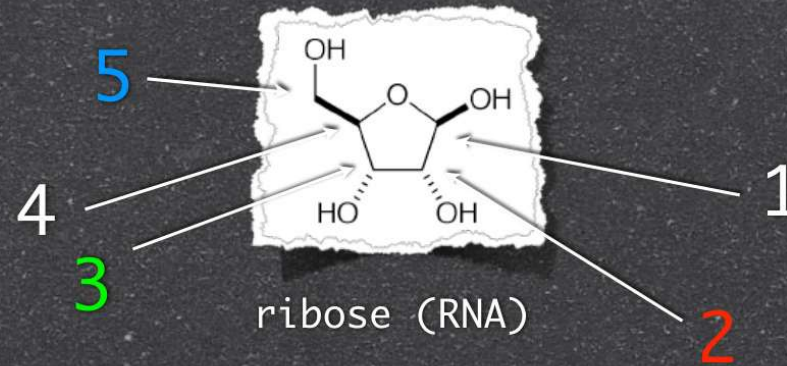


*Nature*, 264, 546-549, December 1977  
Chemistry  
**DNA sequencing with chain-terminating inhibitors**  
(DNA polymerase/nucleotide sequences/bacteriophage φX174)  
F. SANGER, S. NICKLEN, AND A. R. COULSON  
Medical Research Council Laboratory of Molecular Biology, Cambridge CB2 0QH, England  
Contributed by F. Sanger, October 3, 1977

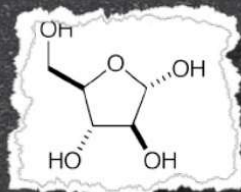
# Enzymatic DNA sequencing



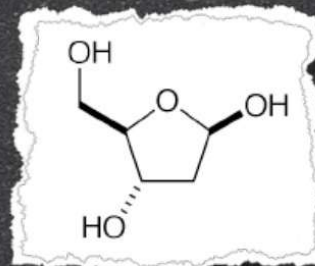
Terminators



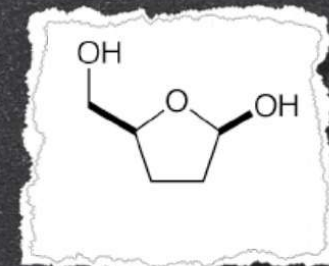
ribose (RNA)



arabinose  
(apples)



deoxyribose (DNA)



dideoxyribose



J. Mol. Biol. 64, 546-556, December 1977  
14, No. 12, pp. 546-556, December 1977  
Chemistry

# DNA sequencing with chain-terminating inhibitors

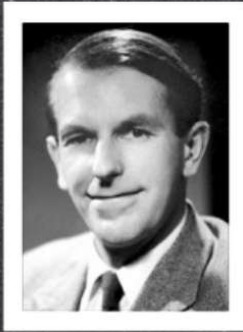
(DNA polymerase/nucleotide sequences/bacteriophage  $\phi$ X174)

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Medical Research Council Laboratory of Molecular Biology, Cambridge CB2 3QH, England

Contributed by F. Sanger, October 3, 1977

## Enzymatic DNA sequencing



### Sanger Recipe

Klenow, Boehringer, Mannheim) (0.2 units). Each mix contained  $1.5 \times \text{H}$  buffer,  $1 \mu\text{Ci}$  of  $[\alpha\text{-}^{32}\text{P}]\text{dATP}$  (specific activity approximately  $100 \text{ mCi}/\mu\text{mol}$ ) and the following other triphosphates

phosphates.

ddT:  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dGTP,  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dCTP,  $0.005 \text{ mM}$  dTTP,  $0.5 \text{ mM}$  ddTTP

ddA:  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dGTP,  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dCTP,  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dTTP,  $0.5 \text{ mM}$  ddATP

ddG:  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dCTP,  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dTTP,  $0.005 \text{ mM}$  dGTP,  $0.5 \text{ mM}$  ddGTP

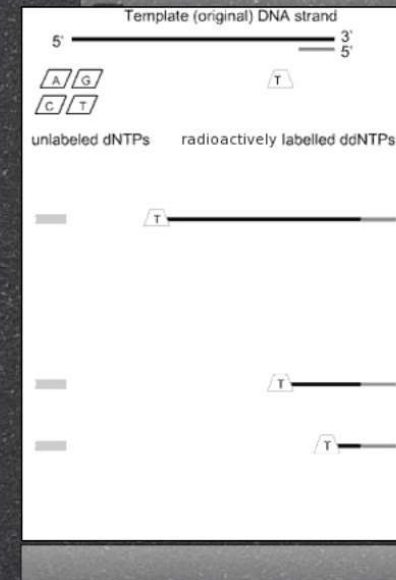
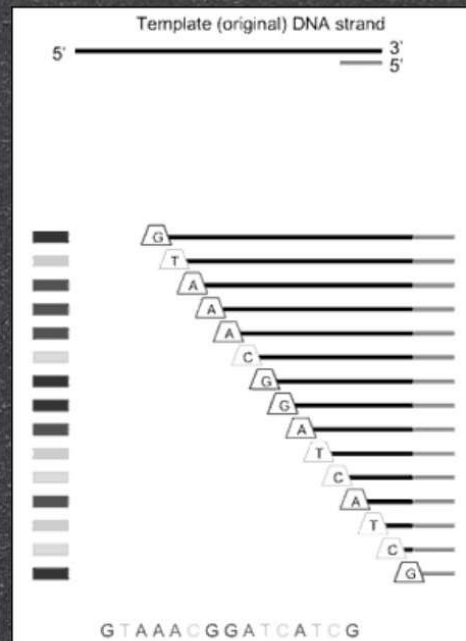
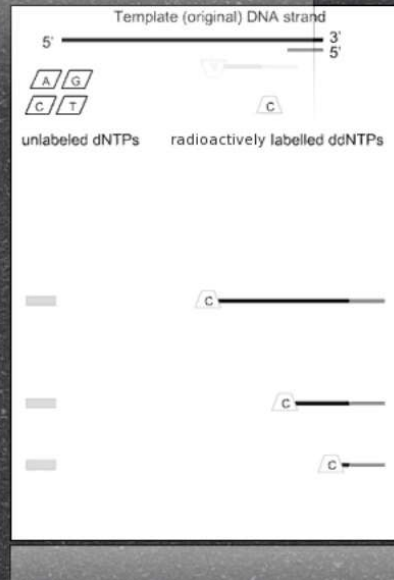
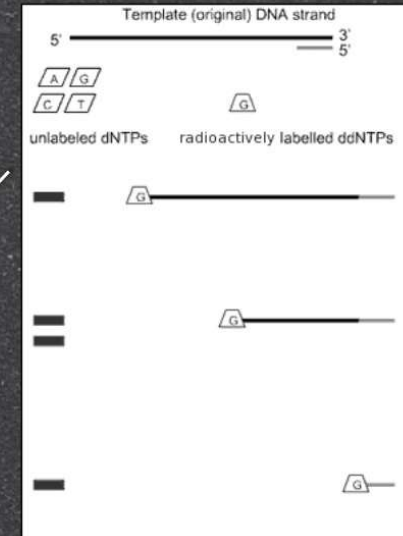
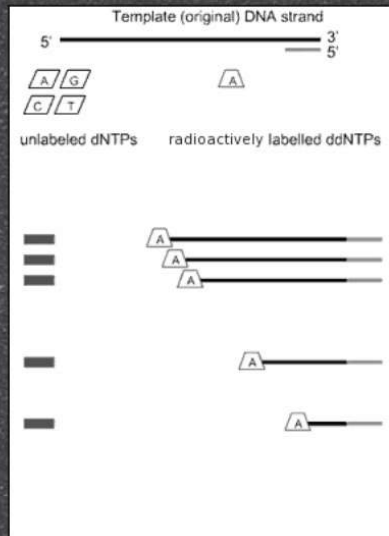
ddC:  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dGTP,  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dTTP,  $0.005 \text{ mM}$  dCTP, approximately  $0.25 \text{ mM}$  ddCTP

(The concentration of the ddCTP was uncertain because there was insufficient yield to determine it, but the required dilution of the solution was determined experimentally.)

araC:  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dGTP,  $0.1 \text{ mM}$  dTTP,  $0.005 \text{ mM}$  dCTP,  $12.5 \text{ mM}$  araCTP

Incubation was at room temperature for 15 min. Then  $1 \mu\text{l}$







J. Mol. Biol. 54, No. 1, pp. 546-550, December 1977  
chemistry

# DNA sequencing with chain-terminating inhibitors

(DNA polymerase/nucleotide sequences/bacteriophage  $\phi$ X174)

F. SANGER, S. NICKLEN, AND A. R. COULSON

Medical Research Council Laboratory of Molecular Biology, Cambridge CB2 3QH, England

Contributed by F. Sanger, October 3, 1977

## Enzymatic DNA sequencing



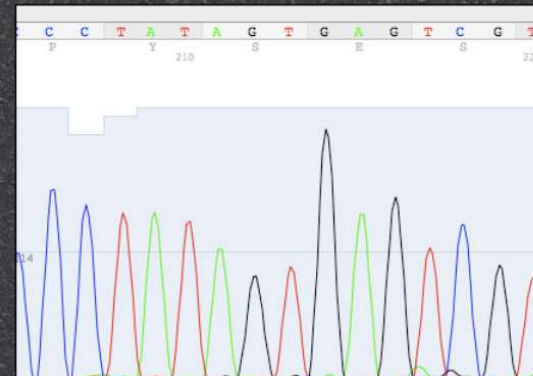
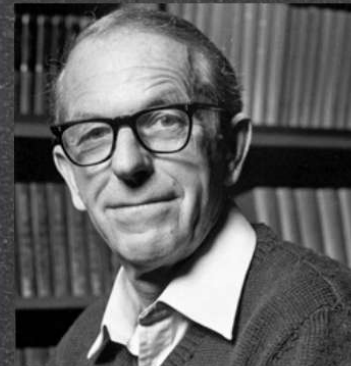


...NATURE, 264, 546-547, December 1977  
chemistry

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Contributed by F. Sanger, October 3, 1977

# Enzymatic DNA sequencing





*Nature* 265: 483-488  
74, No. 13, pp. 540-548, December 1977  
Chemistry

# DNA sequencing with chain-terminating inhibitors

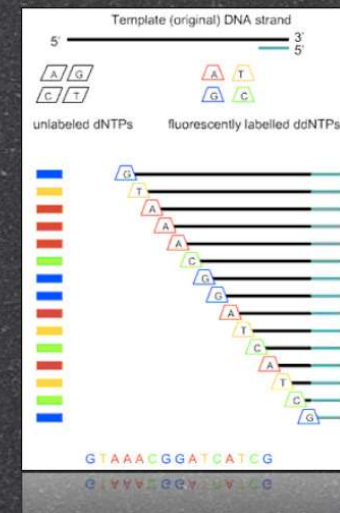
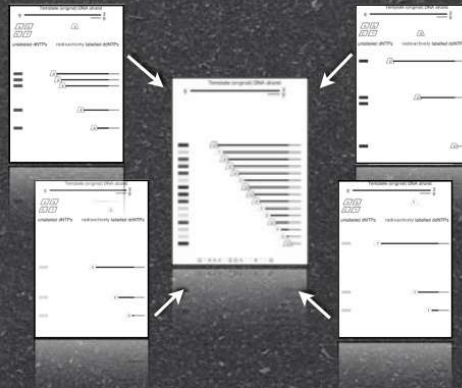
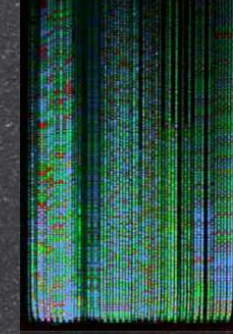
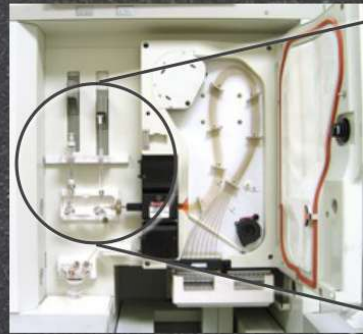
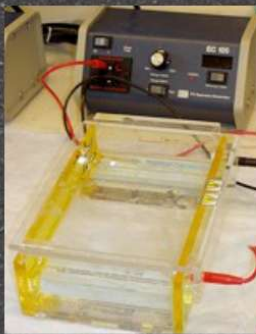
(DNA polymerase/nucleotide sequences/bacteriophage  $\phi$ X174)

F. SANGER, S. NICKLEN, AND A. R. COULSON

Medical Research Council Laboratory of Molecular Biology, Cambridge CB2 2QH, England

Contributed by F. Sanger, October 3, 1977

# Enzymatic DNA sequencing





# DNA sequencing

## Maxam/ Gilbert

Does not require any  
sequence knowledge

Radioactive labelling

Resolution limited by  
polyacrylamide gel

Time-consuming

Error-prone

## Sanger (1977)

Reliable, Easier than  
chemical sequencing

Requires partial  
information about the  
DNA sequence

Radioactive labelling

Resolution limited by  
polyacrylamide gel

Time-consuming

Error-prone

## Sanger (today)

Reliable

Provides the longest  
single reads among all  
sequencing methods  
(900-1100 bp)

Easy-to-handle, one-tube  
fluorescent labelling;  
automatable

Requires partial  
information about the  
DNA sequence

Very expensive, not well  
suited for high-  
throughput sequencing



High-throughput sanger method most famous achievements

**Finishing the euchromatic sequence of the human genome**

International Human Genome Sequencing Consortium\*

2004

**DNA sequence and analysis of human chromosome 8**

**The DNA sequence and biological annotation of human chromosome 1**

**The DNA sequence of human chromosome 21**

2001

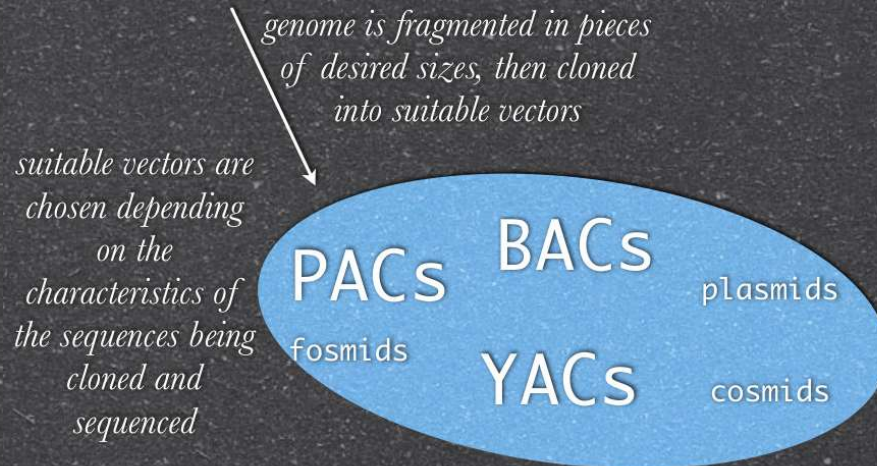
**Initial sequencing and analysis of the human genome**

**The Sequence of the Human Genome**

J. C. Venter, <sup>1</sup> Mark D. Adams, <sup>1</sup> Eugene W. Myers, <sup>1</sup> Peter W. Li, <sup>1</sup> Richard J. Mural, <sup>1</sup> ...  
on O. Smith, <sup>1</sup> Mark Yandell, <sup>1</sup> Cheryl A. Evans, <sup>1</sup> Robert A. Holt, <sup>1</sup>



## Genome library construction



(BACs), but also included some P1-artificial chromosomes (PACs), yeast artificial chromosomes (YACs), fosmids and cosmids; they carried DNA from multiple anonymous sources. We then chose a 'clone tiling path' of 26,720 overlapping clones across the genome, selected a 'sequence tiling path' of directly adjacent, non-overlapping segments from consecutive clones and concatenated these segments

*each clone is fragmented, then individual fragments are cloned, then sequenced to cope with Sanger sequencing length limits*



Shotgun sequencing of each clone

## Sequencing whole genomes workflow

Whole genome draft



Sequence assembly

Contig reconstruction

Annotation!



# Complexity of such a project

Table 1 Bases sequenced in Build 35

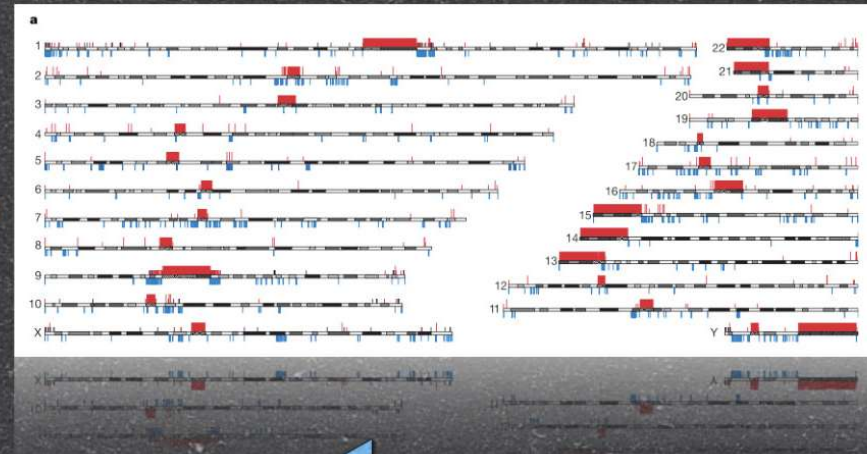
| Centre  | Finished sequence totals (kb) | Finished sequence in Build 35 (kb) |
|---------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| SC      | 919,388                       | 849,650                            |
| WUGSC   | 645,062                       | 583,032                            |
| WIBR    | 562,096                       | 373,760                            |
| JO/SHGC | 485,085                       | 313,988                            |
| BCM     | 320,735                       | 280,963                            |
| RIKEN   | 155,769                       | 112,047                            |
| UWGC    | 145,745                       | 105,573                            |
| GS      | 99,970                        | 78,467                             |
| GTC     | 45,710                        | 32,972                             |
| UWMSO   | 39,227                        | 28,367                             |
| Kato    | 44,905                        | 20,780                             |
| IMB     | 73,677                        | 20,053                             |
| Beijing | 38,079                        | 17,114                             |
| MPIMG   | 9,838                         | 5,673                              |
| GBF     | 8,325                         | 5,547                              |
| UOKNOR  | 18,657                        | 5,311                              |
| TIGR    | 10,360                        | 3,054                              |
| CGM     | 2,788                         | 1,786                              |
| SDSTDC  | 7,792                         | 1,403                              |
| UTSW    | 8,555                         | 196                                |
| Other   | 30,745                        | 11,621                             |
| Total   | 3,672,516                     | 2,851,336                          |

*A number of laboratories has been involved worldwide for 14 years*

*After 14 years, heterochromatic regions are still refractory to high-throughput sequencing*

*Completing the euchromatic sequence is an important goal, but is clearly now a research effort rather than a high-throughput project. Sequencing the human heterochromatin poses an even greater challenge. The current human sequence penetrates only the periphery of the heterochromatin—for example, the pericentric regions on a few chromosome arms<sup>39,40</sup>. This progress has required concerted efforts with specialized mapping techniques and painstaking assembly. The fundamental issue is that current shotgun*

*or extensive highly repetitive sequences or near-exact segmental duplication. Telomeric regions of chromosomes were obtained by using a specialized cloning system ('half-YACs vectors') in which successful propagation required that the human insert DNA provided telomeric function. By far, the most difficult regions of the genome were those*



*Difficult regions must be approached separately*

5. Roughly 2.19 Mb of sequence on chromosome Y was derived directly from the equivalent pseudoautosomal region on chromosome X.  
 centromeric sequences for which no clone was available (see text).  
 (note 2 on heterochromatic sequences). Separate gaps were counted for centromeres and pericentric heterochromatin, even



# Next generation sequencing



pyrosequencing



reversible-terminators  
sequencing

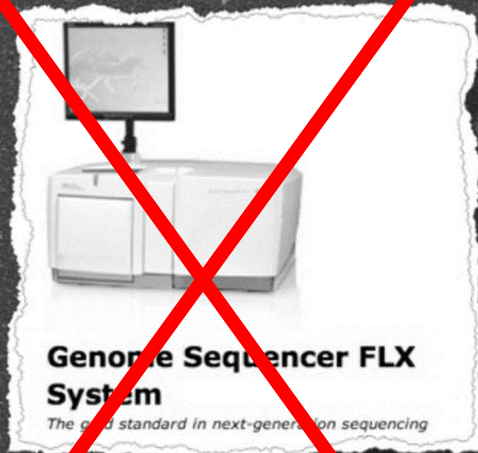


sequencing-  
by-ligation

back in 2007



# Next generation sequencing

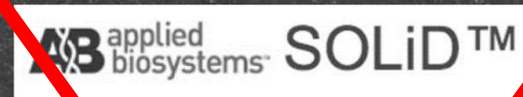


pyrosequencing



reversible-terminators sequencing

2026



sequencing-by-synthesis





# Benchtop Sequencers

MiSeq i100



NextSeq 550



NextSeq 1000/2000



Max output per flow cell

30 Gb

120 Gb

540 Gb

Runtime

4-24 h

11-29 h

8-44 h

Max reads / run (*single*)

100M

400M

1.8G

Max read length

2 × 500 bp

2 × 150 bp

2 × 300 bp

<https://www.illumina.com/systems/sequencing-platforms.html>



# Production-scale sequencers

NextSeq 1000/2000



NovaSeq 6000



NovaSeq X



Max output per flow cell

540 Gb

3 Tb

10.5 Tb

Runtime

8-44 h

13-44 h

17-48 h

Max reads / run (*single*)

1.8G

10/20 B

35/70 B

Max read length

2 × 300 bp

2 × 250 bp

2 × 300 bp

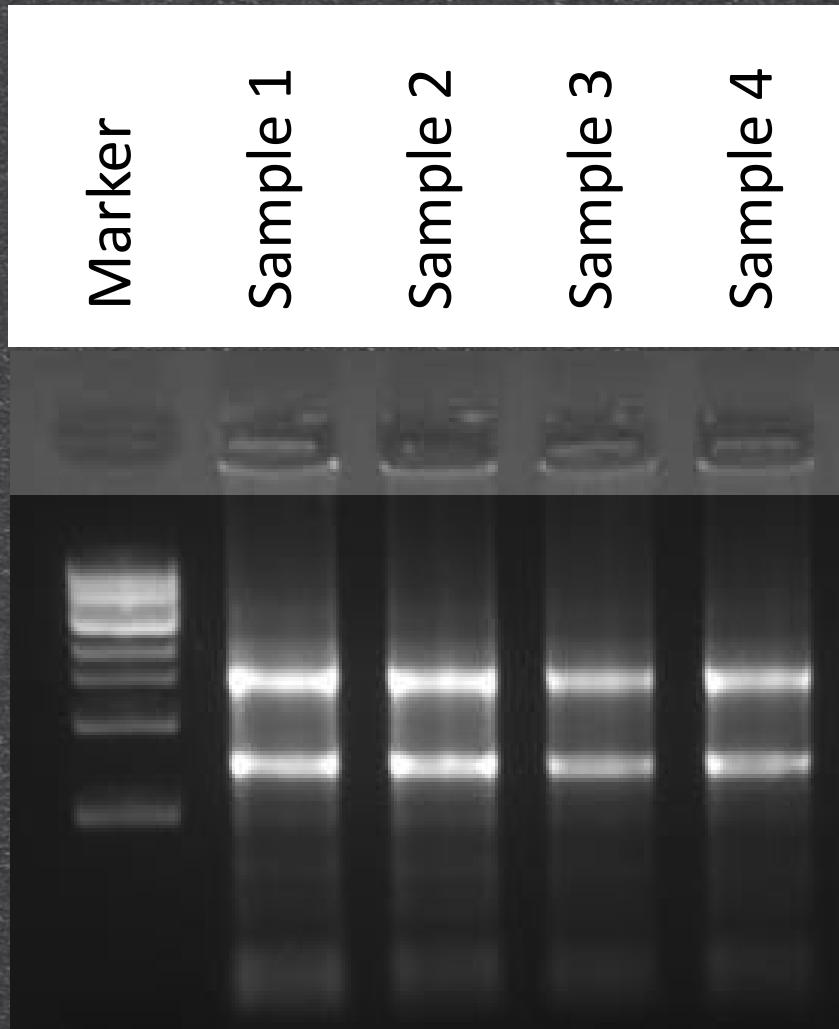
<https://www.illumina.com/systems/sequencing-platforms.html>



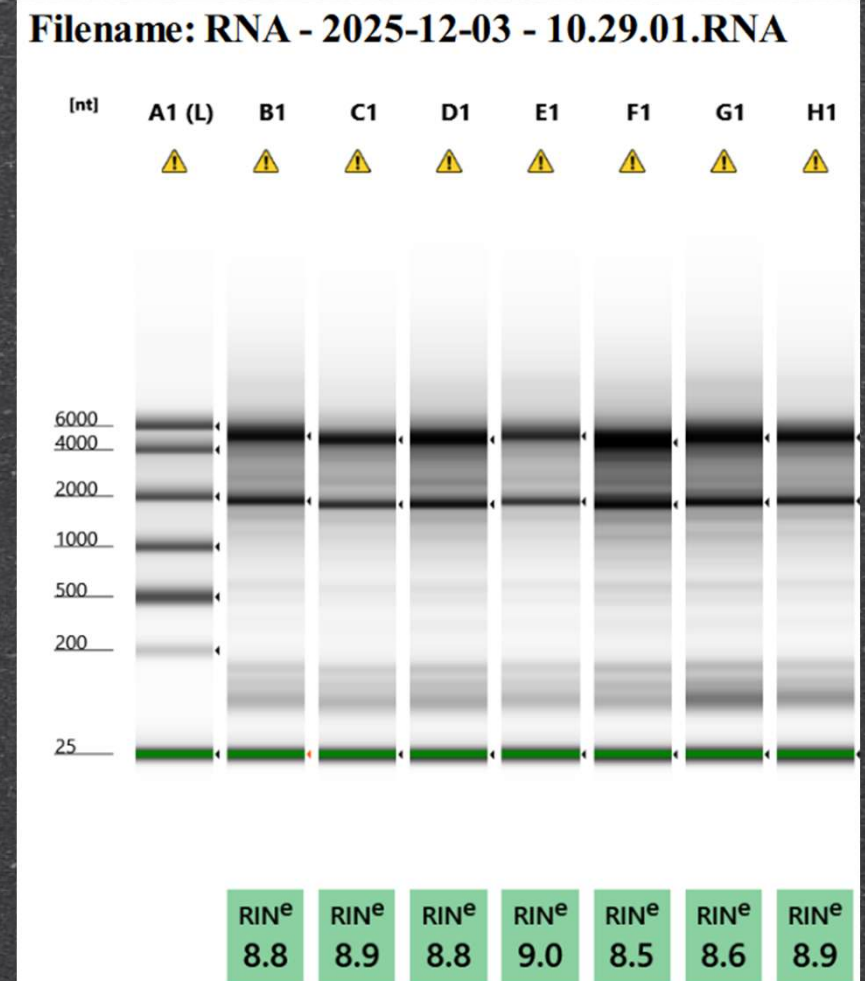
# Example workflow



# RNA quality



1.7% agarose gel

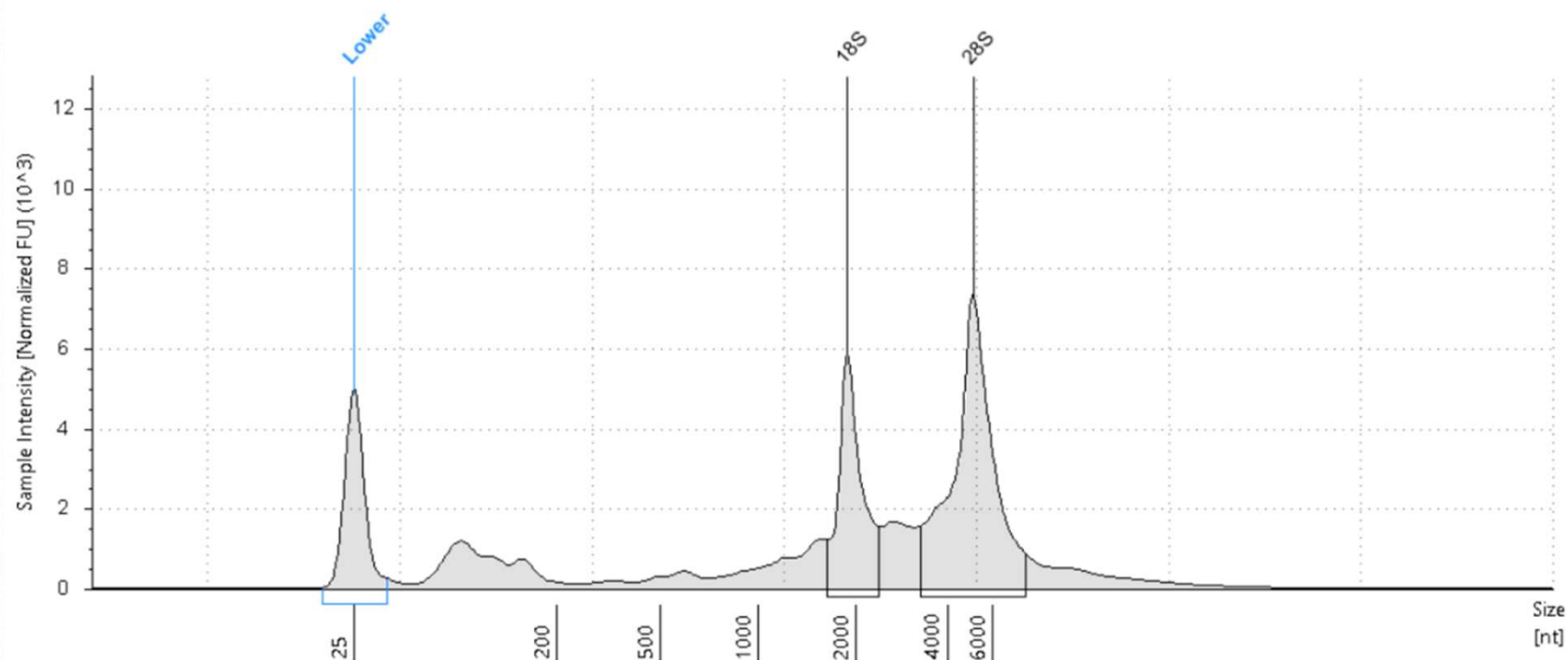


Agilent TapeStation



# RNA quality

**B1: A9L4**



**Sample Table**

| Well | RINe | Conc. [ng/ul] | Sample Description | Alert | Observations                       |
|------|------|---------------|--------------------|-------|------------------------------------|
| B1   | 8.8  | 137           | A9L4               | ⚠     | Caution! Expired ScreenTape device |



# Illumina workflow – library preparation

## 1 Purify and Fragment Messenger RNA

Hands-on: 46 minutes

Total: 1 hour 21 minutes

Reagents: BBB, BWB, ELB, EPH3, RPBX

## 2 Synthesize First Strand cDNA

Hands-on: 5 minutes

Total: 50 minutes

Reagents: FSA, RVT

## 3 Synthesize Second Strand cDNA

Hands-on: 35 minutes

Total: 1 hour 40 minutes

Reagents: 80% EtOH, AMPure XP, RSB, SMM

## 4 Adenylate 3' Ends

Hands-on: 5 minutes

Total: 45 minutes

Reagents: ATL4

## 5 Ligate Anchors

Hands-on: 10 minutes

Total: 25 minutes

Reagents: LIGX, RNA Index Anchors, RSB, STL

## 6 Clean Up Fragments

Hands-on: 30 minutes

Total: 30 minutes

Reagents: 80% EtOH, AMPure XP, RSB

## 7 Amplify Library

Hands-on: 10 minutes

Total: 55 minutes

Reagents: EPM, UDP00XX

## 8 Clean Up Library

Hands-on: 25 minutes

Total: 25 minutes

Reagents: 80% EtOH, AMPure XP, RSB



# Illumina workflow – library preparation

1

**Purify and Fragment Messenger RNA**  
Hands-on: 46 minutes  
Total: 1 hour 21 minutes  
Reagents: BBB, BWB, ELB, EPH3, RPBX

illumina

---

## Purify and Fragment mRNA

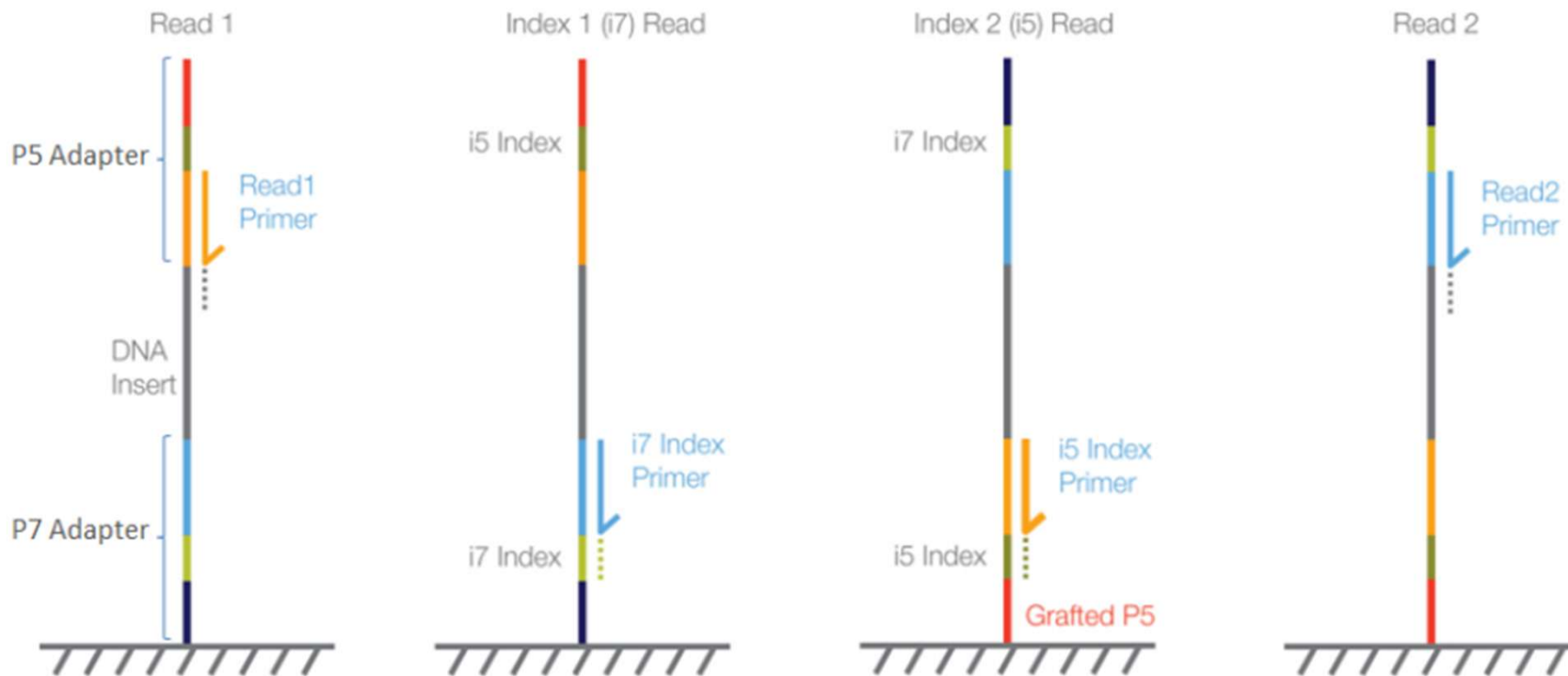
This step uses oligo(dT) magnetic beads to capture messenger RNAs (mRNAs) with polyA tails. The RNA is then fragmented and primed for complementary DNA (cDNA) synthesis.

Random examers



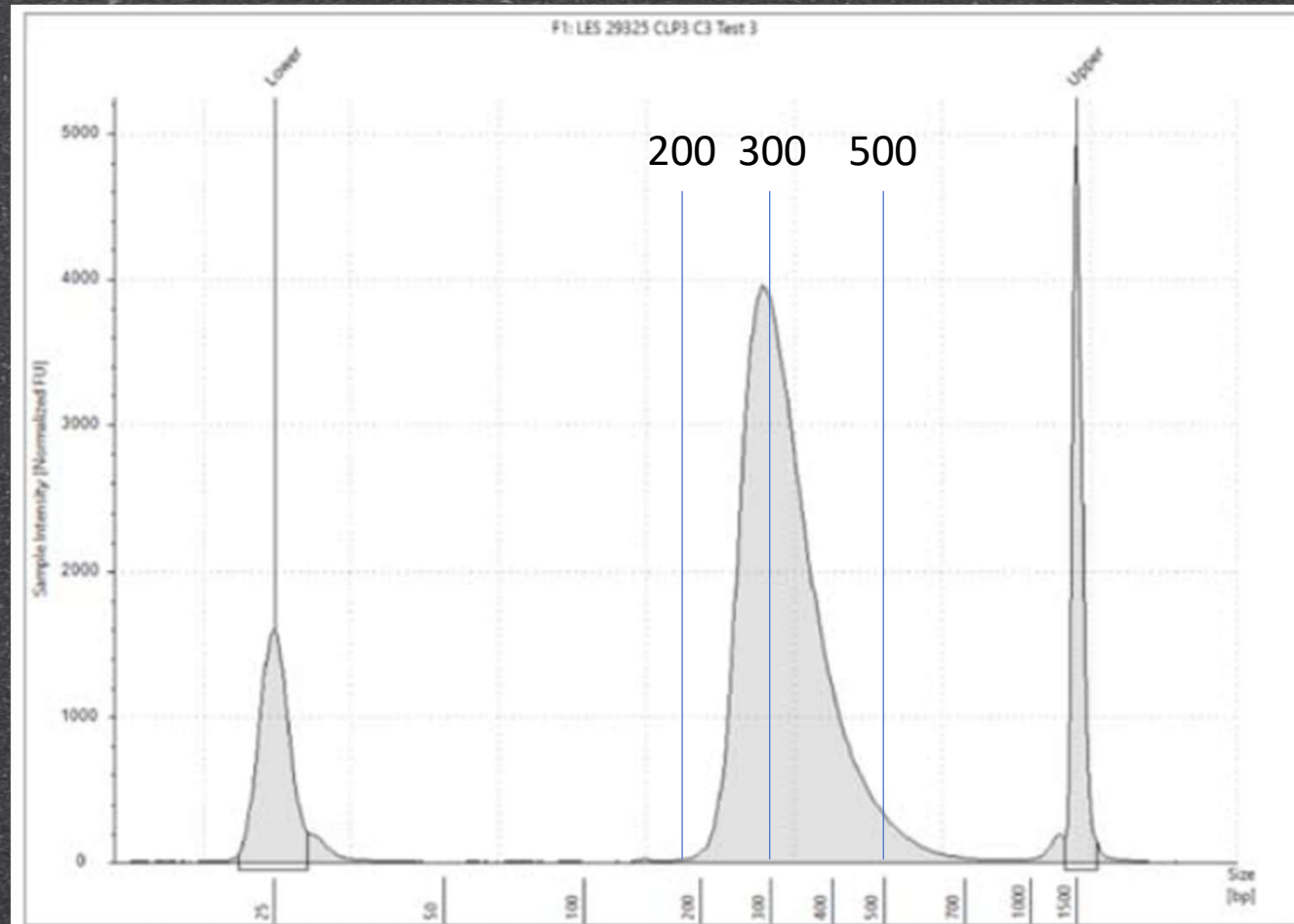
# Illumina workflow – library preparation

Figure 2. iSeq 100, MiniSeq, NextSeq 500/550, NextSeq 1000/2000, and NovaSeq 6000 (with v1.5 reagents)





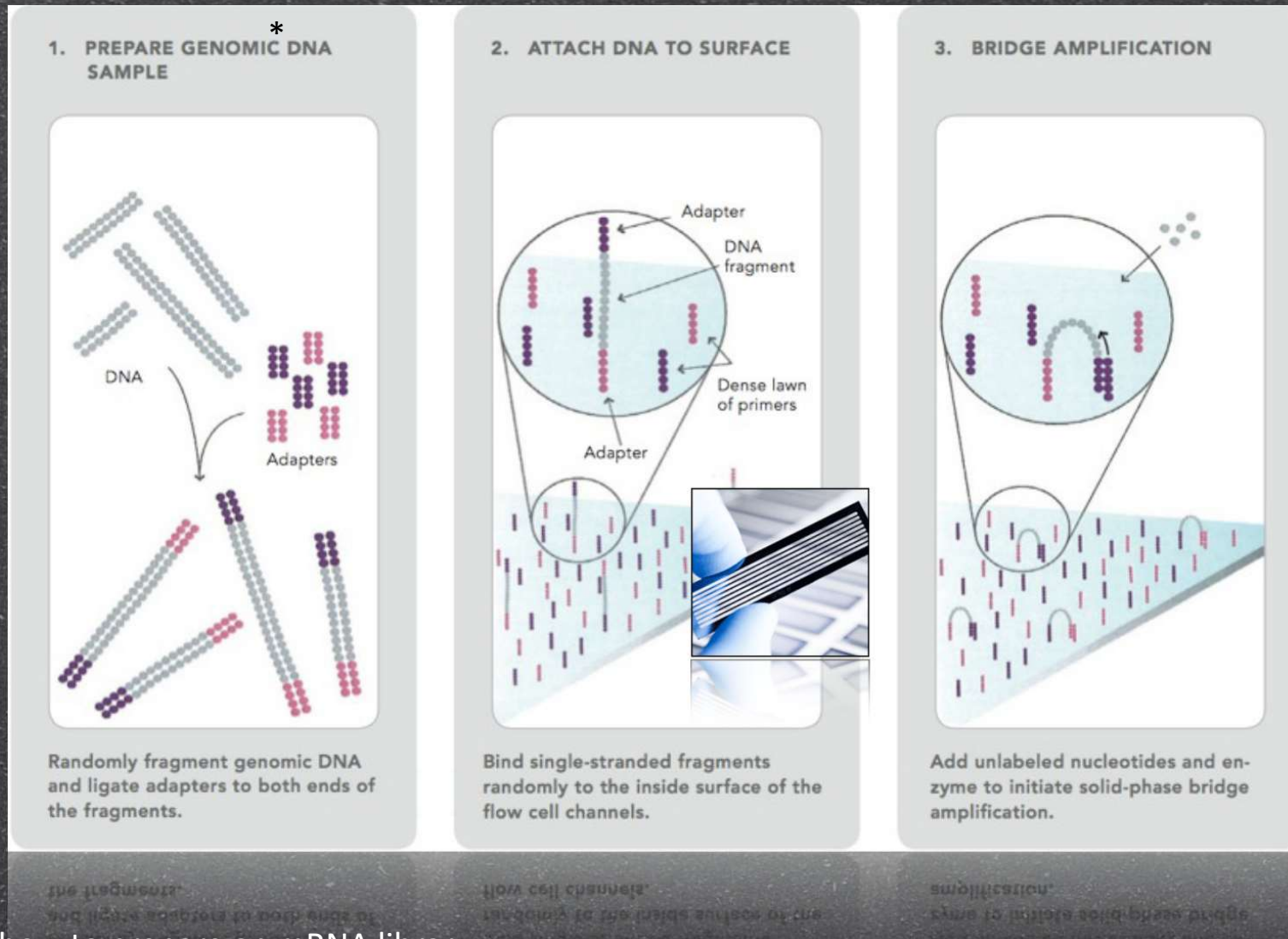
# Illumina workflow – library preparation



The expected insert size depends on the read length



# Illumina workflow

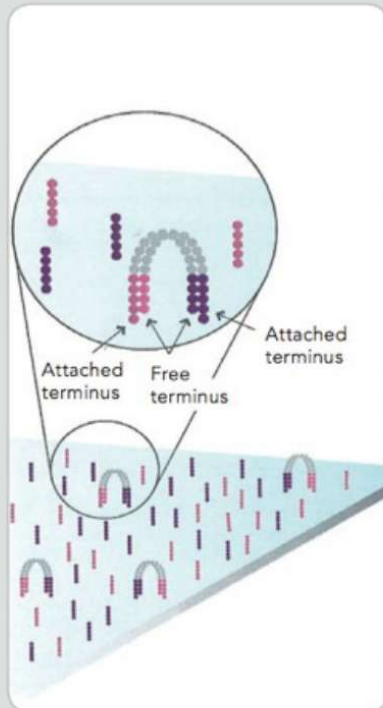


\* we already saw how to prepare an mRNA library



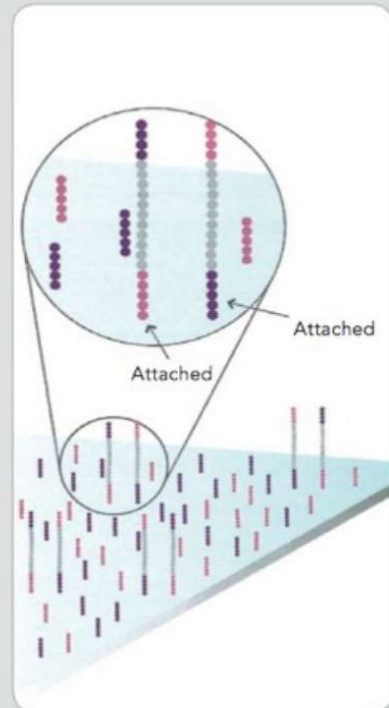
# Illumina workflow

## 4. FRAGMENTS BECOME DOUBLE-STRANDED



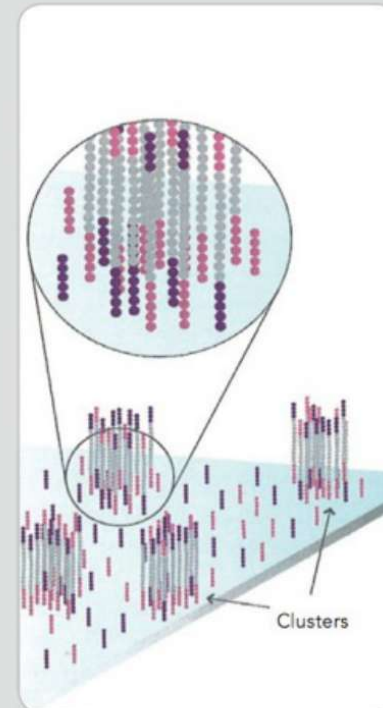
The enzyme incorporates nucleotides to build double-stranded bridges on the solid-phase substrate.

## 5. DENATURE THE DOUBLE-STRANDED MOLECULES



Denaturation leaves single-stranded templates anchored to the substrate.

## 6. COMPLETE AMPLIFICATION

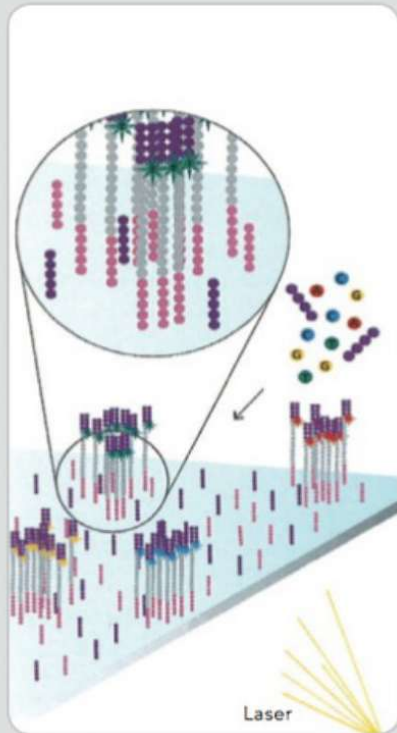


Several million dense clusters of double-stranded DNA are generated in each channel of the flow cell.



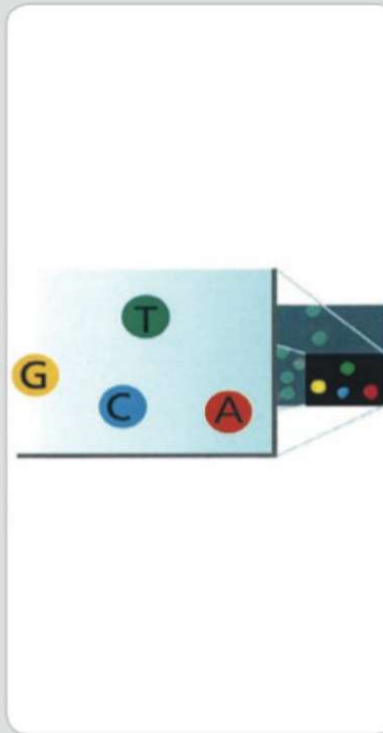
# Illumina workflow

## 7. DETERMINE FIRST BASE



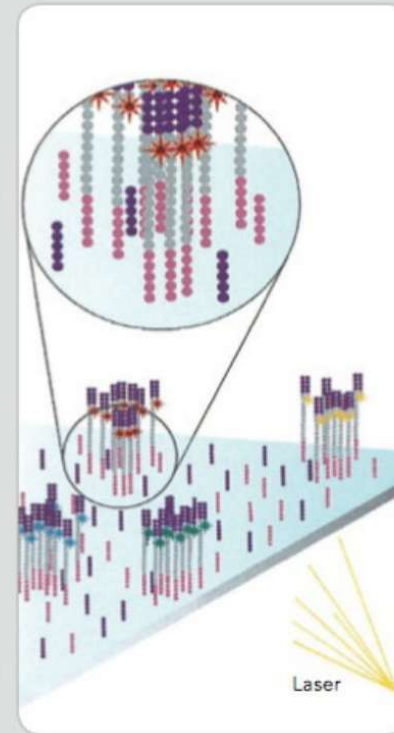
The first sequencing cycle begins by adding four labeled reversible terminators, primers, and DNA polymerase.

## 8. IMAGE FIRST BASE



After laser excitation, the emitted fluorescence from each cluster is captured and the first base is identified.

## 9. DETERMINE SECOND BASE



The next cycle repeats the incorporation of four labeled reversible terminators, primers, and DNA polymerase.



# Tape station





# Tape station

Sample  
tubes

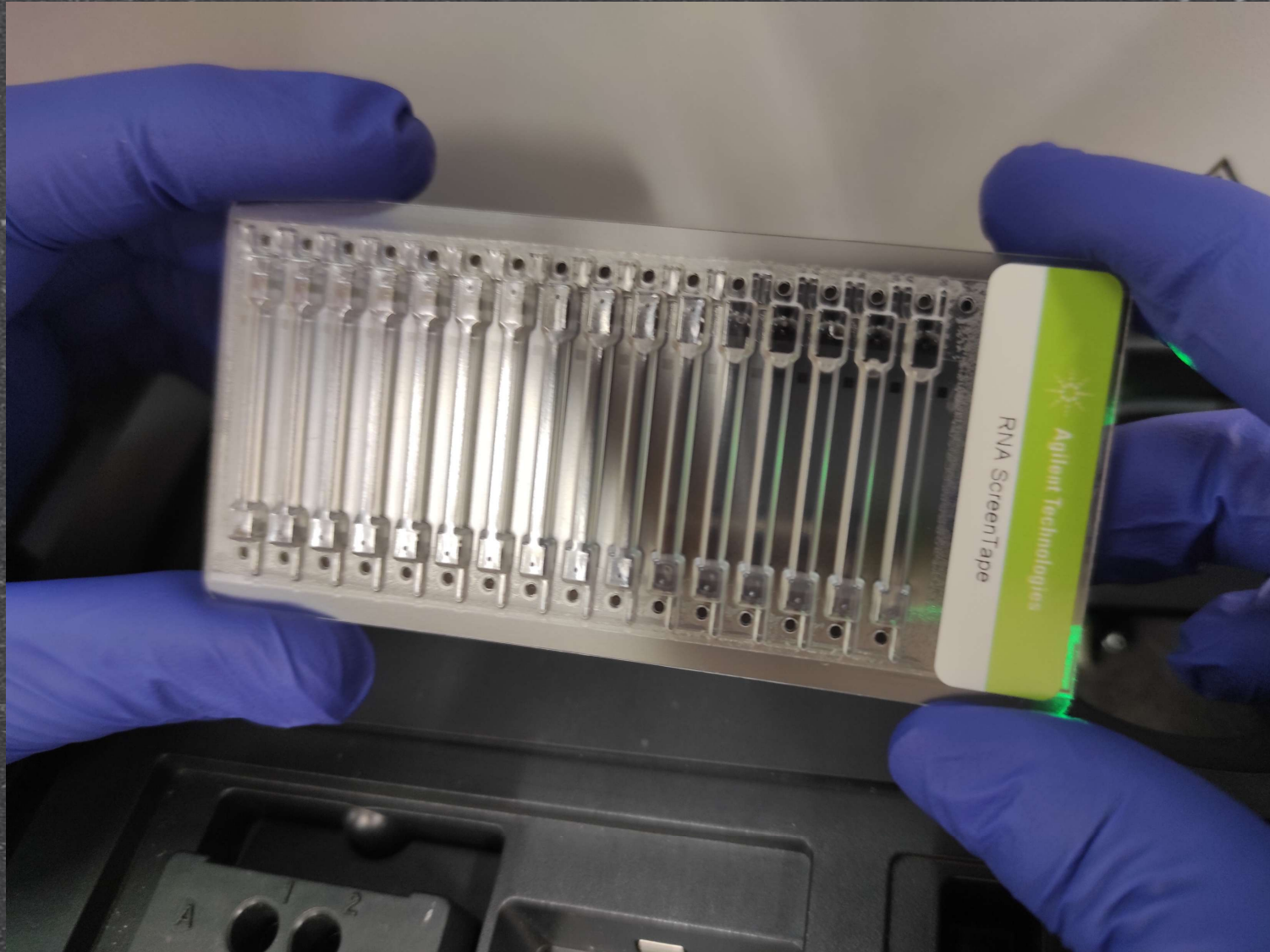
Screeentape

Tips





# Tape station: screentape





Tape station: screentape





# NextSeq 550: Flow cell







NextSeq™ 500/550  
High Output Reagent Cartridge v2

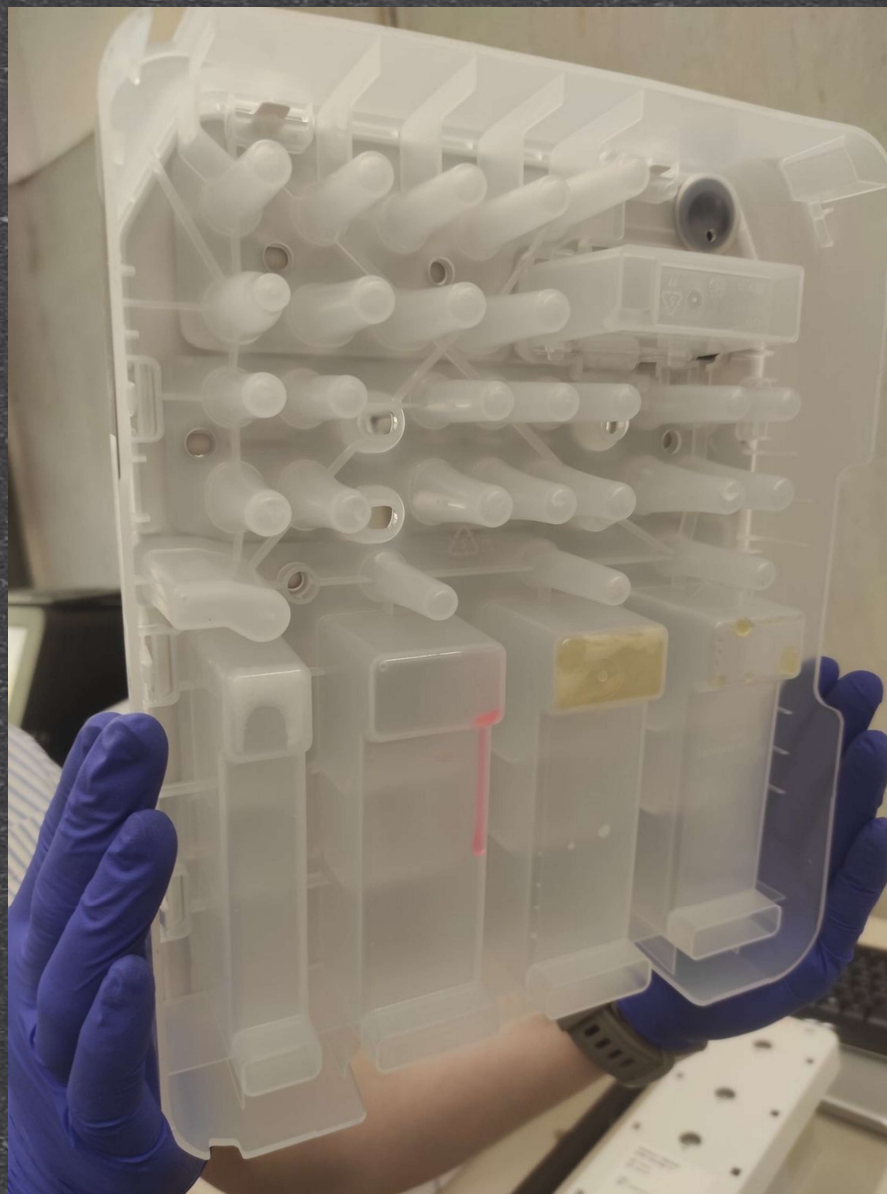
Part Number: 18057931  
Lot Number: 20937890

STORE IN THE DARK

|         |        |
|---------|--------|
| HIGH    |        |
| version | cycles |
| v2      | 150    |

illumina







# NextSeq 550: Buffer cartridge

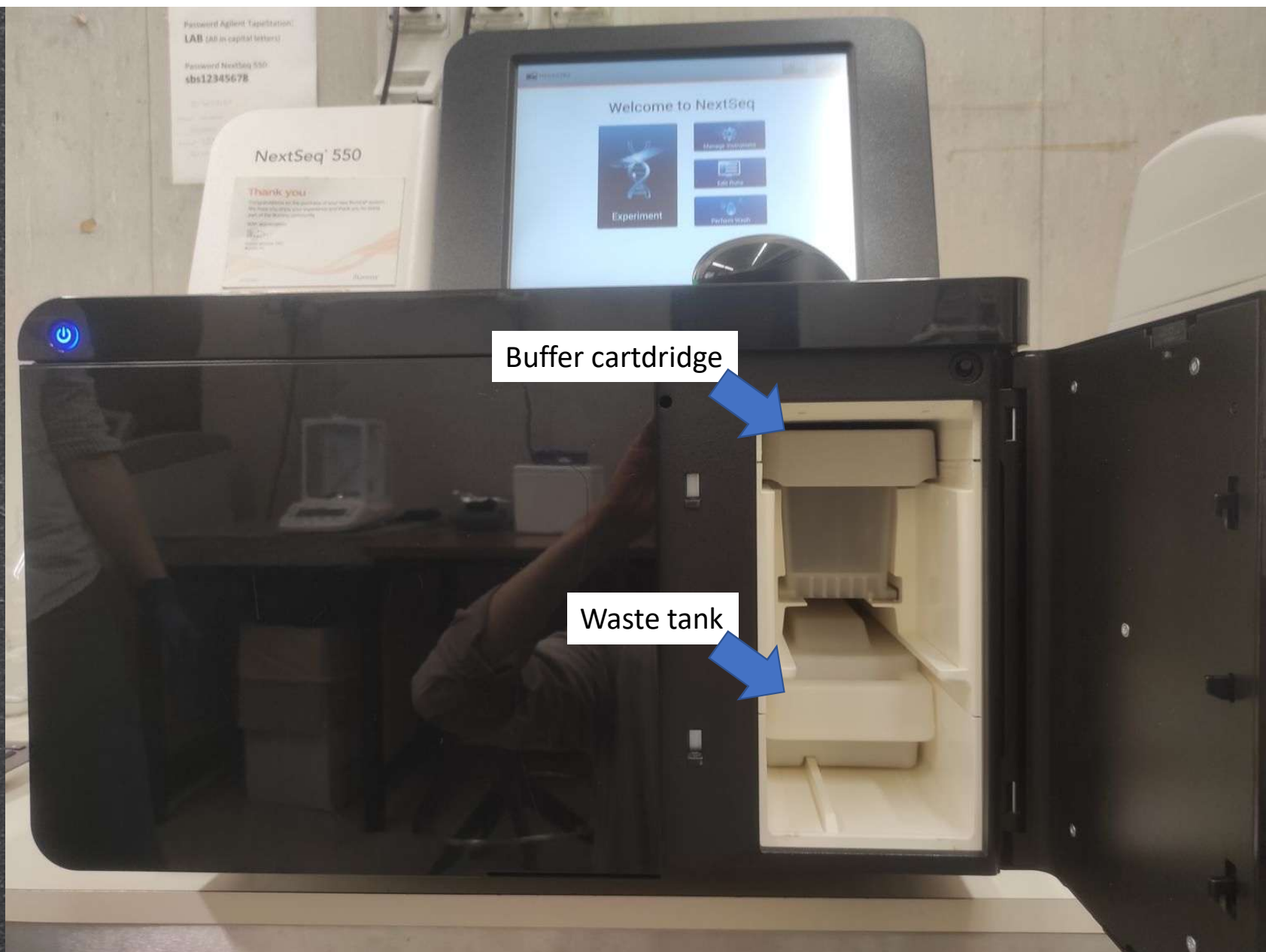






Switch on/off

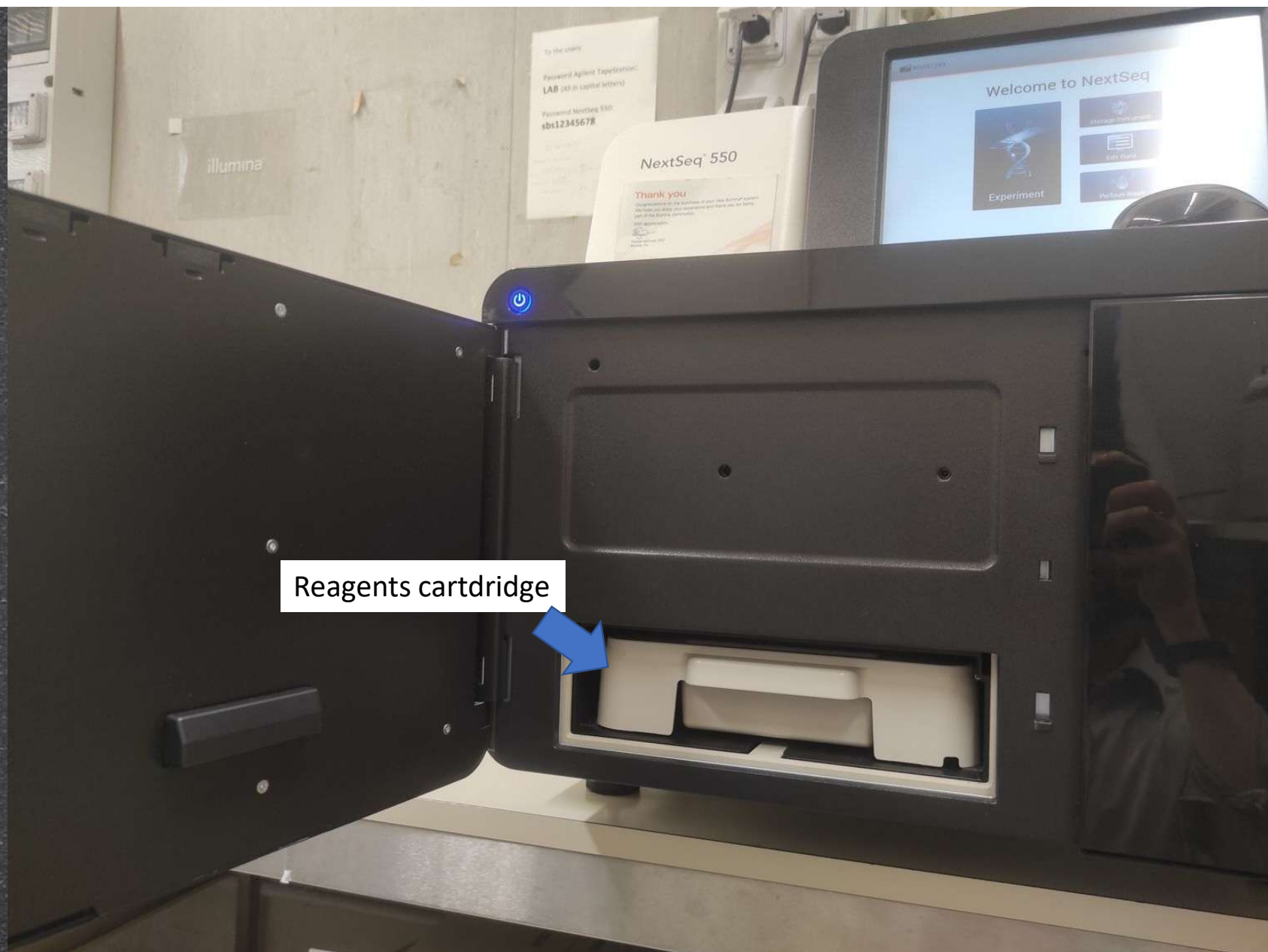




Buffer cartridge

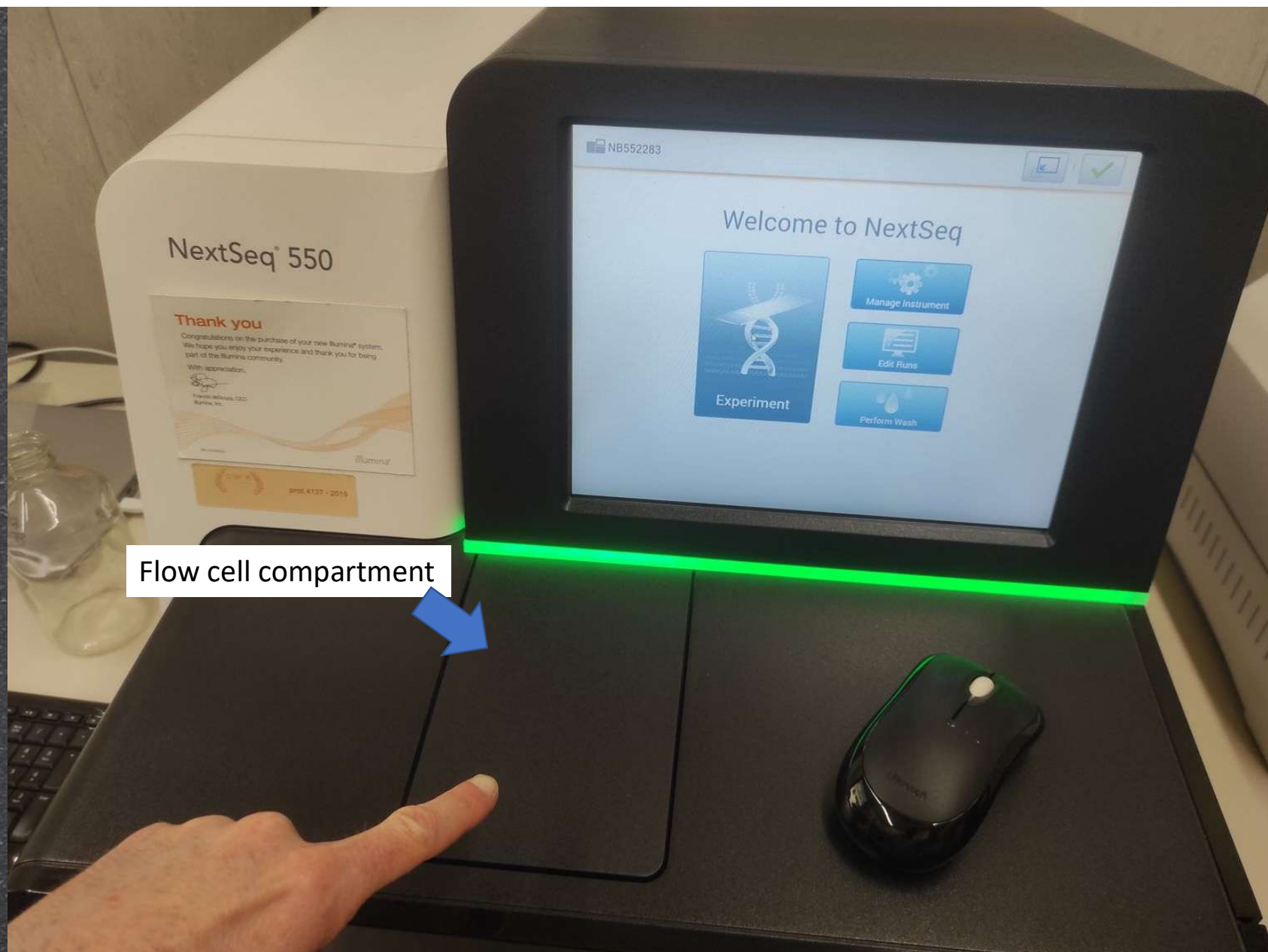
Waste tank





Reagents cartridge





NextSeq 550

Thank you

Congratulations on the purchase of your new Illumina® system. We hope you enjoy your experience and thank you for being part of the Illumina community.

With appreciation,

Frank Illiano, CEO  
Illumina, Inc.

Illumina

prod. 4137 - 2019

NB552283

Welcome to NextSeq



Flow cell compartment



